
MEETING MINUTES

The Eighteenth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

December 18, 2023

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

Please be advised that there will be a Meeting of the Medford School Committee held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall and via remote participation.

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - **6/1**
 - Newly elected School Committee Members were present - Nicole Branley, Aaron Olapade and Erika Reinfeld
 - Two student representatives: Darren Truong and Noah Yurasko
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Good of the Order (*previously tabled on December 4, 2023*) - None
- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Minutes, **December 4, 2023**

Motion to approve by Member Kreatz, Second by Member Ruseau - 6/0/1 passed

- V. Report of Subcommittees - None
- VI. Report of the Superintendent
 - 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Special Recognition of School Committee Members:
 - Member Kathy Kreatz, 8 years of service to Medford Public Schools
 - Member Mea Mustone, 8 years of service to Medford Public Schools
 - Member Sharon Hays, 2 years of service to Medford Public Schools- Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Presentation of engraved bells to each member along with sentiments and pictures

- 2. **Medford Educational Foundation (MEF) Presentation** by Paulette Van der Kloot, President of MEF and former Medford School Committee Member, 146 Pine Ridge Road Medford, MA

Motion to approve grants by Member Mustone, second by Member Kreatz - 6/0/1 passed

- 3. **School Updates:** Medford High School by Principal Marta Cabral and Medford Vocational Technical High School by Chad Fallon, Principal/Director
- 4. **Update:** Medford High School Invited to MSBA Eligibility Phase, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm) - None

- VII. Continued Business - None
- VIII. New Business - None
- IX. Reports Requested

2023-27 Requested by Member Hays and Member McLaughlin

Ad Hoc Report Request: Update on Recommendations from the Spring 2023 MHS/MVTHS Safety, Security, and School Climate Review

Whereas the Medford school committee passed resolutions on 12/6/21 and 11/7/22 to provide funding for an assessment of Medford High School and Medford Vocational-Technical High School to include “recommendations to address moving forward in a manner that prioritizes a healthy school community” and “outline organizational, structural, professional development, and curriculum-based changes needed to address the findings and achieve our district-wide mission”,

Whereas an assessment was completed by Michael Welch in the spring of 2023, with the findings and recommendations discussed at school committee meetings on 5/1/23 and 6/12/23

Resolved, the MPS administration will provide a presentation by the end of February 2024 to update progress on the following recommendations provided in Michael Welch’s report and during subsequent school committee meetings with Mr. Welch:

1. Creation of MHS committees recommended in report (motion passed at 6/12/23 COW meeting)
 - a. Safety and Security Team
 - b. Diversity, Equity & Inclusion Committee
 - c. Committee on Norms for Student Behavior (shared values)
 - d. Unified MHS/MVTHS Schedule Committee
2. Invitation to Mr. Welch to attend an executive session to advise on the next set of teacher contract negotiations (motion passed at the 6/12/23 COW meeting)
3. Updated Memorandum of Understanding with the Chief of Police regarding School Resource Officers
4. Development of consensus about a vision for MPS, with community, caregiver, teacher & student involvement
5. Provide more opportunities for teacher input in decision-making, and build relationships between teachers and administration
6. Parent/caregiver surveys about culture and climate at MHS/MVTHS during 2023-24 school year
7. MHS/MVTHS Associate or Assistant Principal: person/position focused primarily on logistical and management pieces to allow the principal to focus on her role as the academic and instructional leader
8. Mentoring for new administrators
 - a. At MHS - individual mentoring with mentors exterior to the district for the new principal and new AP’s along with group mentoring for all
 - b. Mentoring for new principals at the Roberts and Andrews
9. MHS Security Personnel/Building Monitors - review titles and job descriptions to consolidate into fewer titles. Clarify the scope of responsibilities and training provided for each position.

Date of Request: December 12, 2023

Date Requested to be on Agenda: December 18, 2023

Motion by Member Graham to sever items 2, 3, 4 and 9, second by Member Ruseau - 5/1/1 passed
Motion to approve (minus items 2, 3, 4 and 9) by Member Hays, Second by Member Kreatz - 6/0/1 passed

X. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Marie-Christine Cardillo**, an elementary teacher for 30 years for the Medford Public Schools.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Janet Valentyn**, mother of Donna Laskey, an elementary teacher at the McGlynn School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Elmer "Al" Kountze**, husband of Shirley Kountze, retired principal of the Brooks-Hobbs School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Daniel Gendreau** of Lakeville, cousin of Medford High School Assistant Principal Sheila Freitas-Haley.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Marjorie A. Sanford** who was in the Medford High School Class of 1953 and was a secretary in both the Swan Elementary and Roberts Junior High School for many years.

XI. Next Meeting

January 8, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Kreatz, second by Member Hays - 6/0/1 passed
Meeting adjourned at 7:20 p.m.